

FAQ Knowledge Repository

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# Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!

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*by AiR (Atman in Ravi)*

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| <b>9</b><br>Topics | <b>135</b><br>FAQs |
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This FAQ repository preserves the original teachings of the book, organized by topic so that readers and seekers can quickly find answers to the spiritual questions they carry in their hearts.

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# How to Use This FAQ

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This document is organized into **topic-wise sections**, each containing 15 frequently asked questions along with verbatim answers drawn directly from *Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!* by AiR (Atman in Ravi). Each answer is accompanied by its source — the chapter name, page number, and book title — so you can locate the passage in the original text.

The topics span the full arc of the book's teachings: from understanding why bad things happen and the Law of Karma, to the mystery of death, the nature of destiny, and ultimately the path toward Liberation and Unification with the Divine. You may read it from beginning to end, or jump to the topic most relevant to your current question or life situation.

All answers are taken verbatim or as closely paraphrased as possible from the original text to preserve the author's voice and intention.

# 1. The Law of Karma (Action and Reaction)

## Q1

### What is the Law of Karma?

The Law of Karma states, 'As you sow, so shall you reap.' If you plant apples, you will get apples, not mangoes. It is the law that prevails everywhere in the universe. Nobody can escape from this law.

*Source: Chapter 4: The Universal Law of Action and Reaction | Page 36 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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## Q2

### Why do bad things happen in this world?

No doubt bad things happen in this world, but they are not a dictate of the Divine. Everything in this world unfolds based on a Universal Law — the Law of Action and Reaction. Recently, this has gained popularity as the Law of Karma.

*Source: Chapter 4: The Universal Law of Action and Reaction | Page 36 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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## Q3

### Can anyone escape the Law of Karma?

The Universal Law of Karma cannot be circumvented. Nobody can escape from the law. As we live, we have a current account of Karma. The current account is recording all our current actions, good or bad.

*Source: Chapter 4: The Universal Law of Action and Reaction | Page 38 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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## Q4

### How does the Law of the Boomerang relate to Karma?

This law is also known as the Law of the Boomerang which states that what goes around, comes around. It is very natural for good deeds to beget good responses just as bad deeds can expect bad reactions in return.

*Source: Chapter 4: The Universal Law of Action and Reaction | Page 37 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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## Q5

### What happens to our Karma when we die?

The Universal Law of Karma makes no mistake. It keeps on recording our actions. Even at death, our karmic account is not wiped out. The balance in our karmic account becomes the cause of our next birth. Therefore, all our actions, good or bad, become the cause of our circumstances and we cannot escape from our own actions.

*Source: Chapter 4: The Universal Law of Action and Reaction | Page 37 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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## Q6

### What are the three karmic accounts?

The law seems to have 3 types of accounts. One account is the corpus or the carried forward account with the reservoir of our actions. At the end of our life, whatever be our balance, plus or minus, it gets added to our corpus. It is from this corpus, positive or negative, our next life is decided.

*Source: Chapter 4: The Universal Law of Action and Reaction | Page 37 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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#### Q7

##### **What is a karmic 'opening balance'?**

When we are born, we carry with us some portion of our karmic corpus as an opening balance of our present life. This is the cause of our positive or negative circumstances at birth. Added to the opening balance, are actions of our present life.

*Source: Chapter 4: The Universal Law of Action and Reaction | Page 43 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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#### Q8

##### **Does God control what happens to us through Karma?**

God has no direct role to play in the unfolding of this law. God has created this Universal Law but God doesn't decide whether we will have positive or negative circumstances. God doesn't decide whether good things or bad things will happen in our life. This is decided by the Law of Karma as per our own actions.

*Source: Chapter 4: The Universal Law of Action and Reaction | Page 43 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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#### Q9

##### **Why do we continue blaming God when we know about Karma?**

While the entire universe works on the principles of Universal Laws and the Law of Karma is one such law that we cannot escape from, it is strange that we human beings blame God for what happens in our life. Our ignorance is so deep, that we go about blaming God for the bad things that happen to us on earth.

*Source: Chapter 4: The Universal Law of Action and Reaction | Page 44 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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#### Q10

##### **What is the karmic 'current account'?**

Sometimes, our good and bad actions cause an immediate positive or negative reaction as per the law. But there are times when these deeds get deposited in our account for a future redemption. No human being dies settling their entire karmic account. Death is uncertain and sudden, and whenever it comes, there is an unsettled account of good and bad that gets transferred into our corpus.

*Source: Chapter 4: The Universal Law of Action and Reaction | Page 38 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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#### Q11

##### **Is Karma the only Universal Law?**

There are many Universal Laws prevalent on earth and each of these laws advocates a profound truth. They are natural laws, laws that are unquestionable, laws that apply to all of humanity. It is for us to understand the laws, to accept them and to live by them gracefully. If we don't, we are bound to suffer.

## **Q12**

### **How does the Law of Karma prove itself without direct evidence?**

The Law of Karma doesn't make a mistake, just as the Law of Gravity is perfect. All Universal Laws unfold everywhere in the universe without exception. Just like we cannot prove gravity but we infer that it is in force because every time we throw something up into the sky it is pulled back towards the earth.

*Source: Chapter 5: Apples Can't Grow on Mango Trees | Page 50 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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## **Q13**

### **What does 'as you sow, so shall you reap' really mean in daily life?**

The seeds that we planted yesterday are the trees that will bear fruit today, just as the seeds that we plant today, will become the trees that will bear fruit tomorrow. What is happening in our life today is sometimes beyond our control because it is based on our past actions. However, our future can be controlled because that is based on our current actions.

*Source: Chapter 8: We Control Our Destiny | Page 77 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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## **Q14**

### **Why do good people seem to escape karmic punishment?**

Those who understand the Universal Law of Karma, understand that it is a Law of Cause and Effect. If mangoes are growing on a tree, mangoes are just an effect. The mango seed is the cause. Because of mango seeds, there are mangoes. There cannot be apples. If bad things are happening to some people who seem to be good, somewhere in life, they must have done some bad deeds.

*Source: Chapter 5: Apples Can't Grow on Mango Trees | Page 48 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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## **Q15**

### **Can performing good deeds now erase past bad karma?**

Our present actions can do both — wipe out the sins of our past Karma and lay the seeds of our future through good present actions and create a destiny of our dreams. At the end of our life, whatever be the balance, the ones we carried forward, as well as all the actions of this life, will be accounted, totalled and the balance will be added to the corpus so that it decides our next birth.

*Source: Chapter 4: The Universal Law of Action and Reaction | Page 43 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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## 2. Suffering and Why Bad Things Happen

### Q1

#### Why do bad things happen to good people?

Bad things can't happen to good people. It is just not possible! Such is the Universal Law. While these people may be good, if bad things are happening to them, they must have done some bad deeds. Those who understand the Universal Law of Karma, understand that it is a Law of Cause and Effect.

*Source: Chapter 5: Apples Can't Grow on Mango Trees | Page 47 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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### Q2

#### Why do we experience suffering in life?

We all experience what can be called the 'triple suffering'. We experience the physical pain of the body, emotional pain of the mind and the agony that the ego suffers when it cannot achieve its expectations. Everybody who is born must suffer and ultimately die. This does not mean that there is only suffering. Life is a merry-go-round of pleasure and pain.

*Source: Chapter 9: Realize the Truth | Page 84 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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### Q3

#### Is suffering a punishment from God?

The Creator whom we call God loves us. He cares for us and there is no question of God inflicting misery upon us, least of all to let good people suffer in an unfair manner. God is not responsible for our miseries. As long as we are ignorant about the Law of Action and Reaction, we will never realize the truth and accept its verdict.

*Source: Chapter 3: Is God Responsible for Our Misery? | Page 33 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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### Q4

#### What is the cause of all misery on earth?

What is happening is just a response to our own actions processed by a universal program instituted by the Creator. If this was not so, we would see apples growing on mango trees and jackfruits falling from coconut trees. Just because misery strikes humanity, we can't blame God.

*Source: Chapter 3: Is God Responsible for Our Misery? | Page 32 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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### Q5

#### Can we stop bad things from happening?

Those who understand the law and accept it, do not question whatever happens on earth. They know that they cannot stop certain things from happening as these are our own Karma returning to us. Those who understand the law well, do not question why bad things happen. They do not wonder why good people suffer.

*Source: Chapter 4: The Universal Law of Action and Reaction | Page 41 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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### Q6

## **Why do innocent people suffer while wrongdoers seem to go free?**

The world lives in a dilemma. When bad things happen to bad people and good things happen to good people, it seems fine. But why do good people suffer and why do the scoundrels of this world get away with all their treachery? This is something beyond human comprehension. People are unable to digest this injustice and often question God as to why this is so.

*Source: Chapter 2: Why Do Good People Suffer? | Page 23 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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### **Q7**

## **Why do I feel that my suffering is unjust?**

It is one thing to experience pain, but it is another to suffer the misery, feeling that this world is unfair, or that God is unjust or not powerful enough to help us overcome our suffering. Those who realize the Truth understand the meaning of life, of death, of suffering, and of bliss. They understand the Law of Karma.

*Source: Chapter 9: Realize the Truth | Page 84 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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### **Q8**

## **Does suffering have any purpose?**

When something bad happens, they rejoice, because they realize that their past bad deed is redeemed. The negative is over, and they look forward to the positive to unfold. They don't question a tragedy when it appears, but they are happy that they have endured the tragic result of a bad deed done by them in the past.

*Source: Chapter 8: We Control Our Destiny | Page 80 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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### **Q9**

## **Why do some people suffer more than others?**

Why is there disparity in the fate of young children who have done no harm to anybody? Obviously, this is not some random act of the Creator. The Universal Law ensures that good deeds beget good rewards, just as bad things befall those who commit bad deeds. The law does not know how to execute reverse actions.

*Source: Chapter 6: Why Does a Newborn Suffer? | Page 61 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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### **Q10**

## **Is it possible to live without any suffering?**

Can we escape from misery and pain? As long as we live, it is natural for the body to experience pain. The body ages and as it does, our aches and pains only increase. Can we escape from this pain? The mind is constantly thinking — this constant clutter of the mind causes stress and anxiety.

*Source: Chapter 9: Realize the Truth | Page 84 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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### **Q11**

## **What is 'triple suffering' and how do I overcome it?**

Our triple suffering is completed by the ego. Not only do the body and mind suffer, but the ego is also constantly creating misery. We get angry, depressed, irritated and upset because what we want doesn't happen. The ego creates desires and very often, our desires are not met. We become disappointed and discouraged and we suffer in our defeats.

*Source: Chapter 9: Realize the Truth | Page 85 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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## Q12

### **Why do tragedies seem to strike at random?**

Bad things can't just happen randomly. Sometimes, it is a tsunami that wipes out lakhs of people, an epidemic that destroys communities, or a fire that burns down an entire city. Humanity is unable to decipher why bad things keep happening on earth. But if we understand the Universal Law of Action and Reaction, then we will not question the unfolding of these bad events.

*Source: Chapter 1: Why Do Bad Things Happen? | Page 14 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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## Q13

### **Why is the mind a source of suffering?**

The mind jumps into the past and makes us regret. We nurse, curse and rehearse our hurts and feel sad. Then, it jumps into the future and causes us to fear and worry. While the mind does cause us happiness, it is responsible for our hate, jealousy, regret, fear, worry, revenge, stress and anxiety. As long as we live, we experience joy, but we are not excused from sorrow.

*Source: Chapter 9: Realize the Truth | Page 84 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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## Q14

### **Can suffering be used as a spiritual tool?**

When we experience suffering, we curse and we cry. We don't understand 'why' this suffering appears in our life. If only we did, we would gracefully accept it. Those who understand the ins and outs of the law realize that our account doesn't end at death and sometimes, we may be surprised at how the law is unfolding because we don't know what our carry forward score is.

*Source: Chapter 8: We Control Our Destiny | Page 80 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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## Q15

### **Is there an end to suffering?**

Some people even contemplate suicide so that all the misery of this world could come to an end. But those who realize the Truth, know that death is not the end, it is just a bend. They realize that there is a way to slowly end suffering. It may take time, but it will happen if they constantly and consistently plant positive deeds.

*Source: Chapter 9: Realize the Truth | Page 85 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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### 3. God and the Creator

#### Q1

##### **Is God responsible for our misery?**

God is not micromanaging everything that happens on earth. While God is the producer-director of this drama called 'Life' that unfolds on the humungous stage called the Earth, God is not responsible for all our actions that cause the circumstances on earth as they unfold. We human beings are responsible for whatever happens on earth, but we do not realize this truth.

*Source: Chapter 3: Is God Responsible for Our Misery? | Page 30 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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#### Q2

##### **Is God watching and judging every action of every person?**

One God controlling the circumstances for 8 billion people, moment by moment, giving orders and ensuring that his will unfolds! Ridiculous, this looks impossible! God has set up a universal system through a law that is monitoring our actions and there are automatic rewards and punishments.

*Source: Chapter 3: Is God Responsible for Our Misery? | Page 30 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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#### Q3

##### **Why does God allow so much injustice in the world?**

The Creator seems to have a set of Universal Laws by which the world is governed. It is not practical for God to issue instructions to control each and every action of all people who live on earth. We are ignorant of the Universal Laws, more so, of the Law of Karma, the Law of Action and Reaction, which proclaims that good actions will result in good circumstances, just as bad deeds will cause bad things to happen.

*Source: Chapter 3: Is God Responsible for Our Misery? | Page 32 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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#### Q4

##### **Why do we blame God when things go wrong?**

Why do we blame God when bad things happen? Why do we believe that God is responsible for all our misery? Why do we think that the Creator is so helpless that he is unable to prevent bad things happening to good people? This is because of our ignorance. We are ignorant of the Universal Laws.

*Source: Chapter 3: Is God Responsible for Our Misery? | Page 32 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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#### Q5

##### **How is God like a computer program?**

In today's world, there are millions of computer programs and the whole world is functioning through computers. The computers function through a program. So also, God has created a program. We often hear in the technology world, 'Garbage in, garbage out'. The computer program processes what comes in and appropriately delivers what goes out. So also, God has programmed this world but we seem to be ignorant of it.

*Source: Chapter 3: Is God Responsible for Our Misery? | Page 31 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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#### Q6

## **What is the relationship between God and the Universal Laws?**

God has created this Universal Law but God doesn't decide whether we will have positive or negative circumstances. God doesn't decide whether good things or bad things will happen in our life. This is decided by the Law of Karma as per our own actions. Such is the Universal Law! God is not responsible for bad things to happen. God has created his laws and the laws unfold based on our actions.

*Source: Chapter 4: The Universal Law of Action and Reaction | Page 43 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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### **Q7**

#### **Is God cruel for allowing children to suffer?**

It is not that God is incapable of stopping this, nor is the Creator cruel as some people may seem to think. What is unfolding is nothing but the Universal Law. The suffering of these young children seems to be a suffering of ME — Mind and Ego of the one who was alive in an earlier life and has committed certain deeds.

*Source: Chapter 6: Why Does a Newborn Suffer? | Page 59 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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### **Q8**

#### **Does God love us even when bad things happen?**

The Creator whom we call God loves us. He cares for us and there is no question of God inflicting misery upon us, least of all to let good people suffer in an unfair manner. God is not responsible for our miseries. As long as we are ignorant about the Law of Action and Reaction, we will never realize the truth and accept its verdict.

*Source: Chapter 3: Is God Responsible for Our Misery? | Page 33 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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### **Q9**

#### **Does prayer change our karmic fate?**

The realized ones accept death gracefully, hoping and praying for the one who has departed. But they also know that our prayers will be heard but they cannot undo the actions performed by the one who has died. They know that we cannot undo the bad deeds of our near and dear ones, just like we cannot cause apples to grow on mango trees, no matter what! The law will not permit it.

*Source: Chapter 9: Realize the Truth | Page 88 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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### **Q10**

#### **Is God omnipotent if bad things still happen?**

The Creator is omnipotent, all-powerful and omniscient, knows everything. The Divine is kind and compassionate and has created Universal Laws, which we must understand, accept and follow. If we fail to do so, we suffer. But if we can understand the laws of the Divine, then we can take charge of our actions and control our destiny.

*Source: Chapter 8: We Control Our Destiny | Page 77 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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### **Q11**

#### **What is God's role in this universe?**

God may have written the storyboard, controls certain Universal Laws by which we are born, but God is not giving commands to control everything that happens on earth. God gives both of them the freedom of choice. They can choose their actions, but thereafter, they are responsible for the reactions. God is not responsible for a bad reaction.

*Source: Chapter 3: Is God Responsible for Our Misery? | Page 31 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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## Q12

### **Can we find God by realizing the Truth?**

The moment we realize this Ultimate Truth, we achieve the Ultimate Goal of life. At death, the physical body will die, and we the Divine Soul, who realize we are not the mind and ego, get liberated from the body-mind complex, to be united with the Divine. There is no further birth. All the Karma that belonged to ME, Mind and Ego, drops like a pebble in the ocean and we are freed from it.

*Source: Chapter 11: The Ultimate Goal of Life, Liberation and Unification with the Divine | Page 104 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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## Q13

### **Is it wrong to question God during hardship?**

When they see a tragedy in the drama of life, they watch it like a movie. They realize that they are just observers of the show, not the actors that most people think they are. Therefore, when something happens that causes them pain, they realize that life is both sunshine and rain. There will be loss and gain.

*Source: Chapter 10: Living Blissfully No Matter What | Page 93 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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## Q14

### **How can God be both just and allow so much inequality?**

This book will create a paradigm shift and change people's perspective about problems and tragedies. It will help people realize that the Creator is Just and Powerful and his laws sustain this amazing universe moment by moment, as life unfolds on earth. It will show us a way to accept whatever happens joyously just as it will help us live an ethical life, doing good deeds which will become the seeds of our prosperous future.

*Source: Preface | Page 9 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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## Q15

### **Should we surrender to God's will?**

He met a Spiritual Master who taught him to accept whatever happens with a smile. He also taught him to surrender to the Divine will, and to keep on doing his best, for the law would ultimately unfold in his favour. One day, as if by magic, Sandeep's life was transformed. Everything turned around and he seemed to be a man who was not just successful, but also blissful.

*Source: Chapter 8: We Control Our Destiny | Page 79 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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## 4. Death, Rebirth, and Afterlife

### Q1

#### What happens when we die?

As long as the body is alive, empowered by the Soul, it is the ME — the Mind and Ego, that directs the body to act. When the Soul departs, we experience death and there is no breath. The body lies in front of us, but the ME — the Mind and Ego, moves on to next life, along with the unsettled Karma, deeds or actions that it carries in its cumulative account.

*Source: Chapter 7: The Mystery of Death and Afterlife | Page 71 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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### Q2

#### Is there life after death?

In fact, death and the afterlife are not a mystery anymore. It is just history that unfolds! It is our past that appears as our future, based on our own actions. The only point to understand is that the actions performed in one life appear as the reaction in the next life. Why else would somebody be born in fortunate circumstances and another in unfortunate ones?

*Source: Chapter 7: The Mystery of Death and Afterlife | Page 67 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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### Q3

#### What is reborn — the body, soul, or mind?

We must clearly understand that death is not the end, only the body dies, but the one who was alive, ME — the Mind and the Ego, is reborn and carries the unsettled Karma, not just of the previous life, but sometimes of several lives. Just because I change my shirt and wear a T-Shirt, do I become a different person? So also, the one who was Smith, changed the body to John and later David, but the account of the Karma was the same.

*Source: Chapter 4: The Universal Law of Action and Reaction | Page 40 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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### Q4

#### What is the Soul and does it take rebirth?

The Soul is the Life Energy that causes birth and departs at death. It is just a power supply and is not part of the body-mind complex involved in action and reaction. The Soul is a silent spectator. It is like energy in a bulb that causes the bulb to glow. At death, the Soul or the Consciousness within us merges with the Consciousness that is everywhere.

*Source: Chapter 7: The Mystery of Death and Afterlife | Page 71 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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### Q5

#### What happens to the Soul at death?

At death, our Soul is released into the Cosmic Consciousness that is omnipresent, present everywhere. Many people confuse Soul to be 'Good Souls' and 'Bad Souls'. They even think that the Soul takes rebirth without realizing that Soul is only the Divine Life Energy that arrives at birth and departs at death. The Soul is not reborn.

## Q6

### **Why are some people born fortunate and others unfortunate?**

People who have lived a good pious life, with kindness and compassion, doing good deeds, have built a positive corpus of Karma. Their next birth will be in happy and healthy circumstances. On the contrary, those who have lived bad lives, with cruelty and heartlessness, harming others, causing terror and destruction, build a negative karmic account. They can be expected to suffer in their next birth.

*Source: Chapter 4: The Universal Law of Action and Reaction | Page 42 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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## Q7

### **What is the difference between the body, mind, and soul?**

Just like the computer has hardware but it needs software, our gross physical body needs a software or subtle body which comprises the mind, memory, intellect, and ego. Apart from the hardware and software, what else does the computer need? It needs a power supply without which it would be dead. Our body too will be dead if there was no power supply. Our body and mind are powered by the Soul.

*Source: Chapter 7: The Mystery of Death and Afterlife | Page 70 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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## Q8

### **Does science support the idea of an afterlife?**

Even science believes that energy can neither be created nor destroyed but can only be transformed from one form to another. Recent scientific experiments have proved that the tiniest particle of the human body is nothing but energy. It seems that the energy of ME — Mind and Ego, move into a new body.

*Source: Chapter 7: The Mystery of Death and Afterlife | Page 69 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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## Q9

### **Is death something to be feared?**

One should not doubt the fact that 'death is not the end'. It is only a bend. We have seen many people die and we know beyond doubt that only the body dies. While the body lies in front of us, we declare without hesitation that the person who was alive has passed away. We know beyond doubt that this is not the person but only the dead body of the person.

*Source: Chapter 7: The Mystery of Death and Afterlife | Page 70 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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## Q10

### **Why do some children remember past lives?**

Modern-day technology has made it possible to track how some young children are able to recollect huge volumes of memory of a past life. How else could this be possible without an afterlife? There are many things that a newborn does and we may say that it is their instinct but deeper contemplation will reveal that this instinct is nothing but ME, the Mind and Ego that is reborn with the memory.

*Source: Chapter 7: The Mystery of Death and Afterlife | Page 69 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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## Q11

### **What is the cycle of death and rebirth?**

This world itself seems to be operating on another Universal Law, the Law of Cycles as we see our life to be cyclic. Our life doesn't end at death. The cycle continues. The body dies, but the ME — the Mind and the Ego, continues its cycle in a new body. It doesn't end there. The cycle continues — death, birth, and death again.

*Source: Chapter 7: The Mystery of Death and Afterlife | Page 67 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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## Q12

### **Can we break free from the cycle of rebirth?**

The moment we realize this Ultimate Truth, we achieve the Ultimate Goal of life. At death, the physical body will die, and we the Divine Soul, who realize we are not the mind and ego, get liberated from the body-mind complex, to be united with the Divine. There is no further birth. All the Karma that belonged to ME, Mind and Ego, drops like a pebble in the ocean and we are freed from it.

*Source: Chapter 11: The Ultimate Goal of Life, Liberation and Unification with the Divine | Page 104 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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## Q13

### **What determines the circumstances of our birth?**

Our corpus or warehouse of Karma is not just the closing balance of this life, but probably a cumulative balance of several lives that we may have lived. Each life has a current account for the present life, but each life also has an opening balance. The opening balance is derived from the corpus or warehouse and is to do with what will unfold in our current life.

*Source: Chapter 4: The Universal Law of Action and Reaction | Page 39 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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## Q14

### **Is there heaven or hell after death?**

The reward or punishment is only possible if the person is reborn in a new body. How else would this be possible? Even if one has to go to heaven or hell as claimed by many Religions, how would one go if the body perished on earth? Thus it seems that one is reborn or resurrected in a new body to face one's past actions.

*Source: Chapter 7: The Mystery of Death and Afterlife | Page 68 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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## Q15

### **Who is the real 'me' that carries Karma from life to life?**

A Mind + Ego = ME, never dies. It moves from one body to another along with its Karma. It carries a carried forward corpus or warehouse of Karma. Just because I change my shirt and wear a T-Shirt, do I become a different person? So also, the one who was Smith, changed the body to John and later David, but the account of the Karma was the same.

*Source: Chapter 4: The Universal Law of Action and Reaction | Page 40 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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## 5. Destiny and Free Will

### Q1

#### **Do we control our own destiny?**

As we realize the profound Truth that apples can't grow on mango trees, that bad things can't happen to good people, it leads us to a greater Realization. There is nothing in the world like 'luck'. We are the masters of our destiny. Through our own present actions, we control our future.

*Source: Chapter 8: We Control Our Destiny | Page 75 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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### Q2

#### **Is our life predetermined or do we have free will?**

In reality, some part of our life will definitely unfold as per our past actions. But some part is in our hands. We, the Mind and Ego that drive the body, make choices and these choices become the actions that lead to reactions in our future life.

*Source: Chapter 7: The Mystery of Death and Afterlife | Page 72 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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### Q3

#### **Is there such a thing as luck?**

It is most unfortunate that people think life is made up of chances. They don't realize the fact that it is made up of choices and not chances. What may appear as luck, is actually something that we pluck based on what we sow. For those who believe that our future is based on luck, they must wake up to the Truth that it is not luck, but rather Karma that controls our future.

*Source: Chapter 8: We Control Our Destiny | Page 76 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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### Q4

#### **How can I create a better future for myself?**

If we take charge of our deeds, then we can control what will happen in the future. Our destiny doesn't depend on anyone else, except ourselves. It is not a matter of luck or chance. But rather it will unfold based on our own actions. Today's actions are the cause. Our destiny is just the effect. By controlling the cause, we can control the effect. If we want a better reaction, then we must change our actions.

*Source: Chapter 8: We Control Our Destiny | Page 77 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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### Q5

#### **What is the best analogy for understanding destiny?**

For those who don't understand how this works, the best analogy is that of the car and the road. We are driving a car, but the road is full of bumps. It is a bad road. Can we control the road? No, we can't! The road that appears is nothing but the unfolding of our past actions. However, the car is in our hands. We can control the car, go fast or slow, turn left or right.

*Source: Chapter 8: We Control Our Destiny | Page 78 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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### Q6

#### **Why do siblings from the same family have such different fates?**



What caused the fate of these 3 brothers who grew up together? Why was one super successful and one a dismal failure? Was it just chance or was it choice? Very few people realize that our circumstances, our breaks and opportunities are often the results of our own past actions that are coming back to us.

*Source: Chapter 8: We Control Our Destiny | Page 75 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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#### Q7

##### **Can we change our karma through present actions?**

Whatever we do in this lifetime, good or bad, becomes our current account. If we do a lot of good, we go far beyond our opening balance and create tons of good Karma, sometimes, enough to clear our negative corpus that may be stored in our 'carried forward Karma account'.

*Source: Chapter 11: The Ultimate Goal of Life, Liberation and Unification with the Divine | Page 102 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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#### Q8

##### **How should I respond when misfortune strikes?**

When something happens, something not so good, a misfortune, a tragedy, learn to accept it. It is our own past coming back to us. Those who understand the Universal Law, live gracefully, accepting whatever comes and do their best to create a destiny of their choice. In fact, when something bad happens, they rejoice, because they realize that their past bad deed is redeemed.

*Source: Chapter 8: We Control Our Destiny | Page 80 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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#### Q9

##### **Is there a way to know what my karmic balance is?**

You must not be ignorant of the fact that you carry with you an unsettled account of past Karma that will unfold and interfere with your destiny unless you learn to deal with such circumstances with actions that can overcome such misfortunes. Those who understand the Universal Law and plant positive deeds, eventually create a destiny of their dreams.

*Source: Chapter 8: We Control Our Destiny | Page 80 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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#### Q10

##### **Why don't hard-working people always succeed?**

Man thinks that he can achieve anything. He believes that there is nothing in this world he can't do. But, he doesn't realize that his efforts and equipment are not enough to decide the results of his actions. Sometimes, he does his best but things don't work out the way he wants. He then realizes the importance of the 4th Factor.

*Source: Chapter 8: We Control Our Destiny | Page 76 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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#### Q11

##### **Does accepting fate mean giving up effort?**

Those who realize the Truth and plant positive deeds, eventually create a destiny of their dreams. Not only do they live joyously, peacefully and blissfully, but they also keep on doing good every day that they live. They keep on planting good deeds and they are very careful not to plant a single thorn.

*Source: Chapter 10: Living Blissfully No Matter What | Page 97 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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### Q12

#### **What causes our 'opening balance' at birth to be positive or negative?**

If we have a large positive balance, we are born in very fortunate circumstances. But if we have a large negative balance, then we may be born, only to suffer misery, misfortune or poverty. Our corpus or warehouse of Karma is not just the closing balance of this life, but probably a cumulative balance of several lives that we may have lived.

*Source: Chapter 4: The Universal Law of Action and Reaction | Page 38 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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### Q13

#### **What is the ultimate secret to a happy destiny?**

For one to live peacefully and blissfully, one must have complete trust in the Universal Laws. One must not doubt or question what unfolds on earth. Once all the negatives are over, they know that life will be full of bliss and joy. The sooner we realize the truth, the sooner we will live a life of peace, joy, and bliss.

*Source: Chapter 8: We Control Our Destiny | Page 81 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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### Q14

#### **Can good deeds in this life overcome a negative karmic balance from past lives?**

Our present actions can do both — wipe out the sins of our past Karma and lay the seeds of our future through good present actions and create a destiny of our dreams. At the end of our life, whatever be the balance, the ones we carried forward, as well as all the actions of this life, will be accounted, totalled and the balance will be added to the corpus.

*Source: Chapter 4: The Universal Law of Action and Reaction | Page 43 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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### Q15

#### **Why should we stop blaming God and take personal responsibility?**

Those who understand the law and accept it, do not question whatever happens on earth. They know that they cannot stop certain things from happening as these are our own Karma returning to us. If we realize the truth, we will not ask the question, 'Why do bad things happen to good people?'

*Source: Chapter 4: The Universal Law of Action and Reaction | Page 44 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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## 6. Ignorance and Realization

### Q1

#### What does it mean to 'realize the Truth'?

Putting it all together, it is that good things and bad things happen in this world but nothing is really good or bad. Everything is perfect because it is all unfolding as per a perfect Universal Law. The Truth is that apples cannot grow on mango trees, just as bad things cannot happen to good people. Realization is knowing without doubt that such is the Universal Law that unfolds in our life.

*Source: Chapter 9: Realize the Truth | Page 89 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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### Q2

#### What is spiritual ignorance and how does it cause suffering?

Living with this belief that bad things happen to good people is due to ignorance that envelops humanity. Because we are unaware of the existence of certain Universal Laws and how they function, we live, we exist, and we ultimately suffer and die. But we don't discover why bad things happen to people!

*Source: Preface | Page 9 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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### Q3

#### How does realization change the way we experience life?

What then do the realized ones do? While they pass misery that is caused by bad things that happen, they live blissfully. What is the secret blessing that is received by those who realize the Truth? While all those who realize are liberated from the misery of ignorance and they live blissfully, it all depends on how much realization really sinks into them.

*Source: Chapter 9: Realize the Truth | Page 90 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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### Q4

#### Are realized people heartless when they see others suffer?

Those who realize the truth are not heartless when they see a newborn baby suffer. They are not cruel when they do not shed tears in a sudden tragic accident. Realization of the Truth has made them as strong as steel and while they pass by misery every day that they live, they know beyond doubt that this is the unfolding of the Divine law.

*Source: Chapter 9: Realize the Truth | Page 87 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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### Q5

#### What questions does realization put an end to?

When we do not realize the Truth, what do we do? We ask silly questions like, 'Why do bad things happen to good people? Why do good people have to suffer? Why does a newborn child experience misery? Is God or the Creator cruel?' Realization of the Truth brings an end to such ignorant questions and liberates us from feeling helpless.

*Source: Chapter 9: Realize the Truth | Page 89 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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### Q6

## **How can I begin to realize the Truth?**

AiR believes that unless people ask questions, they will never start a quest and even if they start the quest unless they really investigate, they will not realize the Truth. This Truth cannot be learned in a school, college or university, it must be realized. AiR has dedicated his life to helping people realize the Truth.

*Source: About the Author | Page 119 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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### **Q7**

## **What is the difference between a realized person and an ordinary person?**

To conclude we can classify people into two major categories. The first set of people who think that they are not the body that dies, they move on as a Mind and Ego to another life. These people are quite different from the people who belong to the second category, the ignorant ones who think themselves to be the body. They constantly suffer, both physical pain and mental pain because they don't realize the Truth about the Law of Karma.

*Source: Chapter 9: Realize the Truth | Page 88 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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### **Q8**

## **Why is it so difficult for most people to realize the Truth?**

It is ironical that in this world, a small minority of people are visually blind but the vast majority are spiritually blind. They struggle with life coping with what they call bad luck, crying and praying to God when misfortunes strike.

*Source: Afterword | Page 113 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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### **Q9**

## **Can realization happen gradually?**

My realization transformed my life. I no more worried about what was happening in the world because I knew it was a cosmic drama. When I realized that we are not the body that we seem to be, but rather energy, all my fear disappeared. Realization helped me profoundly in two phases.

*Source: Afterword | Page 111 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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### **Q10**

## **What is the first step towards realization?**

The Ultimate Goal of life has 3 steps. The first step is Realization. If we want to achieve the Ultimate Goal of life, we must realize the Truth, the Truth about the Universal Law and how it unfolds on earth. Realization will make us transcend the ordinary suffering that mortals experience. Whatever happens will not affect us if we live as realized souls.

*Source: Chapter 11: The Ultimate Goal of Life, Liberation and Unification with the Divine | Page 106 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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### **Q11**

## **Does realizing the Truth mean we will no longer face any problems?**

Is it that they escape from all misery and pain? Does Realization give them the gift of only good things and no suffering? Will such people be blessed to live a life where there is no suffering, no pain, and no misery? Will the realized ones not see disease and death? Of course, they will. Like anybody else, they will go

through life, but they will not suffer. They live with peace, joy, and bliss despite whatever happens in life.

*Source: Chapter 9: Realize the Truth | Page 90 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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## Q12

### **What is the difference between pain and suffering?**

It is one thing to experience pain, but it is another to suffer the misery, feeling that this world is unfair, or that God is unjust or not powerful enough to help us overcome our suffering. While there is misery and suffering in this world, and it is sad to see people suffer, we must realize the Truth behind life and suffering.

*Source: Chapter 9: Realize the Truth | Page 84 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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## Q13

### **How does ignorance perpetuate the cycle of suffering?**

Those who are ignorant about the Universal Law, continue to wonder in frustration looking at a young child suffer. This is because they do not realize that this young child is not suffering without reason. They do not understand that the body of this young child carries within a ME, Mind and Ego that has a 'carry forward' account.

*Source: Chapter 6: Why Does a Newborn Suffer? | Page 60 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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## Q14

### **What changes in us when we realize we are not the body?**

In reality, we are neither the body that dies nor the ME — Mind and Ego that leaves at death. We are the Divine Soul. The Soul, the Spirit, Atman or Life Energy, that arrives at birth and departs at death. It is a power that gives us breath and keeps us alive. That is our real identity. Because we live in ignorance, we identify ourselves as the body.

*Source: Chapter 11: The Ultimate Goal of Life, Liberation and Unification with the Divine | Page 104 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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## Q15

### **How does spiritual realization help us accept tragedy?**

Those who realize the Truth, realize that these seemingly good people must have some history of deeds that are not so good. Whether they are sins committed in secret or bad deeds of a distant past, they realize that the Universal Law of Karma makes no mistake. Otherwise you would see apples growing on mango trees. But that is impossible! The Universal Law will not permit it.

*Source: Chapter 9: Realize the Truth | Page 87 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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## 7. Living Blissfully and Inner Peace

Q1

### How can I live blissfully no matter what happens?

Those who realize the Truth, live a life of bliss, peace, and joy. What is the secret of their Happiness? How do they manage to smile despite all their suffering? Realization of the Truth gives them this gift of eternal joy and everlasting peace.

*Source: Chapter 10: Living Blissfully No Matter What | Page 92 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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Q2

### What does it mean to see life as a cosmic drama?

Those who realize the Truth accept this world as a Cosmic Drama. They know that we are just actors, we come and we go and this world is nothing but a big show! The ones who realize the Truth, live with detachment and dispassion. They see without doubt that we come into this world with nothing and when we go, we take nothing.

*Source: Chapter 10: Living Blissfully No Matter What | Page 92 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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Q3

### How do realized people react to tragedy and loss?

The tragedies of life cannot rob their peace. They know whatever is happening, is happening as per the Universal Laws. More so, they know that they can do nothing about it. They realize whatever has been sown, will reap exactly what it deserves. There is no mystery or need for any contemplation once we realize the Truth.

*Source: Chapter 10: Living Blissfully No Matter What | Page 95 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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Q4

### Is it possible to smile and rejoice when something bad happens?

When something seemingly bad happens, they rejoice. They are happy that a bad deed committed in the past has been redeemed. The negative has been cancelled and they live with hope that now the positive will unfold. If something unpleasant happens again, they celebrate again because they know that they can't escape from their own past actions.

*Source: Chapter 10: Living Blissfully No Matter What | Page 96 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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Q5

### How do I develop equanimity and balance in life?

He learned to deal with life and he learned to laugh at his failures. He knew that he could not escape from his own past actions, but he looked forward to all the goodness that came to him like a boomerang. He learned how to accept the Divine will and surrender to the power of the Divine. His failures no more caused him misery, nor did he get too attached to success. He lived a balanced life.

*Source: Chapter 10: Living Blissfully No Matter What | Page 97 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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Q6

## **Does seeking bliss mean ignoring the pain of others?**

How do the realized ones live? Not only do they live joyously, peacefully and blissfully, but they also keep on doing good every day that they live. They keep on planting good deeds and they are very careful not to plant a single thorn, any evil because they know that it will come back to them.

*Source: Chapter 10: Living Blissfully No Matter What | Page 97 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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### **Q7**

## **What are the practical steps to living peacefully despite hardship?**

Those who realize the Truth are not affected by whatever happens in the world. Outwardly, they will show their compassion, care, and concern. But internally, they are not disturbed. They live as observers of this drama called life and they accept whatever is happening, knowing that it is the unfolding of the Universal Law.

*Source: Chapter 10: Living Blissfully No Matter What | Page 97 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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### **Q8**

## **What is the secret of someone who smiles even through cancer or disease?**

Chellaram was suffering from cancer but he was blissful. His body experienced physical pain but he knew that he was not the body. He was the Divine Soul. He did not let the misery affect him. Although death was around the corner, he would wake up every morning and visit the poorest of the poor. Although he was suffering, he did not let his suffering affect his bliss.

*Source: Chapter 10: Living Blissfully No Matter What | Page 92 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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### **Q9**

## **How can I stop being affected by other people's behaviour?**

Dominic was a realized Soul. He had a strange wife and disrespectful children. Still, he did not live a life of misery. Whenever his wife caused him trouble, he would view it as a movie he was watching. He could not control her actions but he did not let her actions control his reaction.

*Source: Chapter 10: Living Blissfully No Matter What | Page 93 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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### **Q10**

## **Can bliss survive physical disability or loss?**

Robert was unfortunate to lose one leg in an accident but it did not stop him from travelling the world. Although Robert was either in a wheelchair or on crutches, it did not stop him from exploring the world. To him, the story of his life was such that his leg was his pain, but his resources were his boon. He learned to live a life of joy and enjoyed his life movie as it unfolded scene by scene.

*Source: Chapter 10: Living Blissfully No Matter What | Page 94 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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### **Q11**

## **How do I stop labelling things as 'good' or 'bad'?**

They learn to live not labelling anything as good or bad because they know everything is perfect. Be it a comedy or a tragedy, they enjoy both scenes in the drama of life, with equanimity. They go one step further which makes normal people think they are crazy. When something seemingly bad happens, they rejoice.

### **Q12**

#### **How should I react to failure to maintain inner peace?**

Initially, he would resist failure, but now, he would consider it to be a sunset that was causing temporary darkness and he knew that the sun would soon rise again. He learned how to accept the Divine will and surrender to the power of the Divine. His failures no more caused him misery, nor did he get too attached to success.

*Source: Chapter 10: Living Blissfully No Matter What | Page 97 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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### **Q13**

#### **What is the role of detachment in living blissfully?**

Those who realize the Truth accept this world as a Cosmic Drama. They know that we are just actors, we come and we go and this world is nothing but a big show! The ones who realize the Truth, live with detachment and dispassion. They see without doubt that we come into this world with nothing and when we go, we take nothing. They live with this Truth and don't let misery overtake their peace and joy.

*Source: Chapter 10: Living Blissfully No Matter What | Page 92 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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### **Q14**

#### **Can a person of realization transcend even the Law of Karma?**

While the realized ones live blissfully, there are a few who are blessed. They are so blessed, that they transcend the Law of Karma. They go beyond the Law of Action and Reaction, Cause and Effect. They are the very few fortunate ones who escape from the suffering of this world as they achieve the Ultimate Goal of life.

*Source: Chapter 10: Living Blissfully No Matter What | Page 98 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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### **Q15**

#### **What attitude should we carry when enduring hardship?**

Sheela seemed to be a very powerful woman. Tragedies came into her life, one after the other. But she knew that these tragedies were her own deeds returning to her. Every time something bad happened, she would smile rather than frown because she knew that one more negative deed was redeemed from her account.

*Source: Chapter 10: Living Blissfully No Matter What | Page 95 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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## 8. Liberation and the Ultimate Goal of Life

### Q1

#### What is the Ultimate Goal of life?

The Ultimate Goal of life has 3 steps. The first step is Realization. If we want to achieve the Ultimate Goal of life, we must realize the Truth, the Truth about the Universal Law and how it unfolds on earth. This takes us to the second step of the Ultimate Goal — Liberation. And then, those blessed ones experience the third and final step of the Ultimate Goal: Unification with the Divine.

*Source: Chapter 11: The Ultimate Goal of Life, Liberation and Unification with the Divine | Page 106 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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### Q2

#### What is Liberation and how do I attain it?

Realization of the Truth liberates us from all misery and sorrow. Although bad things seem to happen, we are unaffected by these things. We are able to transcend suffering post Realization and we are liberated from all kinds of misery and pain. The body may suffer, but we, the ones alive in the body, are liberated from suffering.

*Source: Chapter 11: The Ultimate Goal of Life, Liberation and Unification with the Divine | Page 106 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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### Q3

#### What is Unification with the Divine?

Unless there is Realization of the Truth, which happens when we overcome all ignorance and unless we are liberated from all misery and sorrow as we live as the Divine Soul, not as the body or ME — the Mind and Ego, we can never experience Unification with the Divine. While Realization and Liberation happen during our lifetime, it is only at death that we can experience Unification.

*Source: Chapter 11: The Ultimate Goal of Life, Liberation and Unification with the Divine | Page 107 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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### Q4

#### Who am I in reality?

In reality, we are neither the body that dies nor the ME — Mind and Ego that leaves at death. We are the Divine Soul. The Soul, the Spirit, Atman or Life Energy, that arrives at birth and departs at death. It is a power that gives us breath and keeps us alive. That is our real identity. Because we live in ignorance, we identify ourselves as the body.

*Source: Chapter 11: The Ultimate Goal of Life, Liberation and Unification with the Divine | Page 104 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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### Q5

#### How does a liberated soul live?

Such a person is a liberated Soul, although alive. Nothing affects a realized one. He lives with a steady intellect, discriminating the myth from the Truth, renouncing pleasures of the body and mind, living with discipline and desire for Liberation and the Lord. Such a person lives in eternal peace and joy, being

conscious of his true identity, realizing that he is the manifestation of the Divine.

*Source: Chapter 11: The Ultimate Goal of Life, Liberation and Unification with the Divine | Page 105 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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## Q6

### **What is Yoga in the context of spiritual liberation?**

One who lives transcending Karma, lives a life of Yoga, of union with the Divine. Yoga may be of devotion, meditation, education or action. All these are different forms of Yoga, an offering to the Divine in complete surrender. There is no Ego that creates 'my' actions. Just as the body will die at death, the ME — Mind and Ego will also die, liberating the Soul to unite with the Divine.

*Source: Chapter 11: The Ultimate Goal of Life, Liberation and Unification with the Divine | Page 105 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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## Q7

### **Can we transcend Karma completely?**

Because we live in ignorance, thinking that we are the 'I' — the ego, the mind and the body, we consider our actions as 'my actions,' and thus, we create Karma. As we create Karma, we have to be reborn to redeem our Karma. When we realize we are not the ME, then we don't create any Karma. We live as the Divine Soul and do whatever is the Divine will as an instrument of the Divine.

*Source: Chapter 11: The Ultimate Goal of Life, Liberation and Unification with the Divine | Page 104 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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## Q8

### **How is the three-step Ultimate Goal connected?**

Unless there is Realization of the Truth and unless we are liberated from all misery and sorrow as we live as the Divine Soul, not as the body or ME — the Mind and Ego, we can never experience Unification with the Divine which happens when the body dies. Once we realize the Ultimate Truth that we are not the body, mind, and ego but the Divine Soul, we get liberated from the body-mind complex.

*Source: Chapter 11: The Ultimate Goal of Life, Liberation and Unification with the Divine | Page 107 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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## Q9

### **Is Liberation possible for everyone?**

A very few try to escape from Karma. They are the ones who go on a quest to realize who is doing the Karma and who receives the reward of the Karma. In this quest to find the Truth about the law, some very fortunate ones are graced upon with this Ultimate Realization. Not everybody can reach this second step of the Ultimate Goal. Liberation is a rare gift.

*Source: Chapter 11: The Ultimate Goal of Life, Liberation and Unification with the Divine | Page 101 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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## Q10

### **What happens to a liberated soul after death?**

Those who achieve this are liberated from the cycle of death and rebirth. They become one with the Divine and do not come back to live as a ME — Mind and Ego, in a body to experience joy and sorrow. They unite

with the Divine and are transported to an abode of bliss, unknown to common man.

*Source: Chapter 11: The Ultimate Goal of Life, Liberation and Unification with the Divine | Page 105 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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#### Q11

#### **What is the difference between a person who understands Karma and a truly liberated soul?**

A good chunk of mankind today, understand this Universal Law. They don't need to be taught that apples can't grow on mango trees. They know that if bad things are happening, it is their own Karma. A very few try to escape from Karma. They are the ones who go on a quest to realize who is doing the Karma and who receives the reward of the Karma.

*Source: Chapter 11: The Ultimate Goal of Life, Liberation and Unification with the Divine | Page 101 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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#### Q12

#### **What is the war that even realized people must fight?**

There is a very tiny group, a minority, who realizes that they are neither the body nor the mind but the Divine Soul. However, they experience a war within with their own Mind and Ego — ME. The ME does not permit them to live with their realization. If they succeed they are liberated but if they don't, they also suffer.

*Source: Afterword | Page 112 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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#### Q13

#### **Is the purpose of life just to be happy, or is there something deeper?**

What is the Ultimate Goal of life? Most people live a life like a yoyo. They experience both pleasure and pain. The realized ones face miseries, tragedies, and misfortunes, but they realize apples can't grow on mango trees. While the realized ones live blissfully no matter what, not all of them who understand Karma are able to transcend Karma. Very few fortunate human beings realize the Truth and transcend this Universal Law. This is the Ultimate Goal of our life.

*Source: Chapter 11: The Ultimate Goal of Life, Liberation and Unification with the Divine | Page 100 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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#### Q14

#### **How did the author himself achieve realization?**

It was much later in life that I was fortunate to meet my spiritual master. He taught me exactly how the law of Karma works and how we must learn to celebrate when something goes wrong, not regret it. My master was a genius. He not only taught me about Karma, but guided me how to live a life of surrender and acceptance. He led me on a path to realize the truth and this changed everything.

*Source: Afterword | Page 110 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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#### Q15

#### **What is Moksha, Enlightenment, or Nirvana?**

If we want to escape from all misery to live a life of Eternal Peace and Everlasting Joy, the answer is MEN — Moksha, Enlightenment, and Nirvana. These are the three most tenable concepts that help us reach our Ultimate Goal of Liberation and then Unification with the Divine. The words may be different, but this is the

one secret to everlasting Happiness.

**Source:** *Chapter 11: The Ultimate Goal of Life, Liberation and Unification with the Divine | Page 105 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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## 9. Newborns, Children, and Inherited Karma

### Q1

#### **Why do innocent newborns suffer from disease and disability?**

If we ponder deeply into the suffering of young kids, we will realize a profound Truth. These young kids may look tiny in size, but there is a history that they carry with them which is very long. These children may appear to be just born, but they have an account of their previous actions that have not been redeemed. The suffering that we see in these children is not by chance, nor is it God's choice.

*Source: Chapter 6: Why Does a Newborn Suffer? | Page 58 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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### Q2

#### **Is it unfair that a newborn baby has to suffer?**

Those who understand the law, realize that there can be no injustice in this law. It works on a Universal Principle of Action and Reaction. Why else would some children be born in fortunate circumstances and some in unfortunate ones? Why is there disparity in the fate of young children who have done no harm to anybody?

*Source: Chapter 6: Why Does a Newborn Suffer? | Page 61 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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### Q3

#### **Why is a child born blind or with a serious illness?**

According to the Law of Action and Reaction, if I commit some actions in America, and I shift base to India, I will not escape from my actions. The law will inflict upon me what I deserve. So also it is the same with ME — Mind and Ego. It deserves the fruit of my actions. Sure, I might have dropped my previous body, but the one who is alive is the same person, the same ME — Mind and Ego.

*Source: Chapter 6: Why Does a Newborn Suffer? | Page 59 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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### Q4

#### **What is the 'carry forward' karmic account that a child is born with?**

The suffering of these young children seems to be a suffering of ME — Mind and Ego of the one who was alive in an earlier life and has committed certain deeds. While the action was over in the previous life, the reaction was incomplete. The deeds were completed, but the reward or punishment was not. The seeds were planted in the previous life, but the suffering that we see are the fruits of those seeds that we cannot see.

*Source: Chapter 6: Why Does a Newborn Suffer? | Page 59 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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### Q5

#### **Does a child's suffering also affect the parents karmically?**

When we see a young child suffering, the suffering is not just of the child, but of everybody around, including the mother and father. The suffering of the parents must be due to an unsettled account apparently unknown to them. Even to the child, the suffering is that of the Mind and Ego, it is not the young child that seems to suffer.

*Source: Chapter 6: Why Does a Newborn Suffer? | Page 60 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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## Q6

### **Is a child's suffering proof that God is cruel?**

It is not that God is incapable of stopping this, nor is the Creator cruel as some people may seem to think. What is unfolding is nothing but the Universal Law. The law is not cruel or unkind. The law is just making sure that there are apples on apple trees and there are mangoes on mango trees.

*Source: Chapter 6: Why Does a Newborn Suffer? | Page 59 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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## Q7

### **Why do some children seem naturally talented or gifted?**

A young child suddenly starts playing the piano. How did the child ever learn to play the piano? It is a skill that must have been developed earlier. How else could somebody just be an expert in playing the piano? Probably, it is another faculty associated with the mind, the memory that is reborn as this child.

*Source: Chapter 7: The Mystery of Death and Afterlife | Page 69 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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## Q8

### **Does a child's suffering have a purpose or is it random?**

Suffering can't just happen to anybody without reason. It is the result of something and this is not an assumption, but rather a presumption based on Universal Laws that exist on earth. The Law of Cause and Effect makes us understand that there cannot be an effect without a cause. If we light a fire, then there will be smoke. Similarly, when we see smoke, we understand there must be a fire somewhere.

*Source: Chapter 6: Why Does a Newborn Suffer? | Page 60 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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## Q9

### **Is it possible for a child to be born without any karmic debt?**

The Law of Action and Reaction doesn't close the account so easily. It tracks every action of every person, not only when we are alive but even after death and our karmic score is carried forward life after life. The suffering of these young children seems to be a suffering of ME — Mind and Ego of the one who was alive in an earlier life.

*Source: Chapter 6: Why Does a Newborn Suffer? | Page 58 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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## Q10

### **How should parents react when their child suffers from birth?**

If children are suffering, there is no doubt that parents, family, and anybody who sees the suffering will feel sad. But if we want to realize the Truth behind the misery, we must understand how this Universal Law of Action and Reaction works. It cannot be changed or manipulated — it is a Universal Law!

*Source: Chapter 6: Why Does a Newborn Suffer? | Page 61 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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## Q11

### **Can a child's negative karmic account be cleared during their lifetime?**

Just as these Universal Laws can't be changed, controlled or stopped as they unfold on earth, children will continue to suffer if they carry with them an account of bad deeds that have not been redeemed. This does not make this world a cruel place, nor the Creator unjust and harsh. If we want to understand the source of

this suffering, then we must get into the details of who actually suffers.

*Source: Chapter 6: Why Does a Newborn Suffer? | Page 62 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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## Q12

### **Why are some children born into wealth and luxury while others into poverty?**

If we have a large positive balance, we are born in very fortunate circumstances. But if we have a large negative balance, then we may be born, only to suffer misery, misfortune or poverty. Why else would some people suffer and some celebrate during their next journey on earth? It seems there is no other reason than their own past actions that are the cause of joy or sorrow in their next birth.

*Source: Chapter 4: The Universal Law of Action and Reaction | Page 42 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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## Q13

### **How can the suffering of a newborn be explained to someone who doesn't believe in past lives?**

While there seems to be no doubt that there is an afterlife, modern-day technology has made it possible to track how some young children are able to recollect huge volumes of memory of a past life. Even science believes that energy can neither be created nor destroyed but can only be transformed from one form to another.

*Source: Chapter 7: The Mystery of Death and Afterlife | Page 69 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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## Q14

### **Is the newborn's body suffering or the mind and ego?**

This law is very complex and beyond common understanding. Those who contemplate the suffering of young children realize through inference that if I was a young body, my body was not suffering, but it was ME — my Mind and Ego that was suffering in the new body that appeared on earth. It was not a new story that started at birth, but rather a continuum of several lives.

*Source: Chapter 6: Why Does a Newborn Suffer? | Page 59 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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## Q15

### **What is the deeper meaning behind the disparity we see in children's lives?**

Why else would some children be born in fortunate circumstances and some in unfortunate ones? Why is there disparity in the fate of young children who have done no harm to anybody? Obviously, this is not some random act of the Creator. If such was the law of the Divine, then one would see apples on mango trees, just as one would see pineapples, cherries, and strawberries growing on every other bush.

*Source: Chapter 6: Why Does a Newborn Suffer? | Page 61 | Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!*

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This FAQ document is based entirely on *Why Bad Things Can't Happen to Good People!* by AiR (Atman in Ravi) (AiR Institute of Realization, Bangalore, 2019). It has been prepared as a searchable knowledge repository to make the author's original wisdom easily accessible to readers and seekers.

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